University of Hyderabad
(AC - 96)

Subsequent to circulation of minutes of the 96th Academic Council meeting among all the members, observations have been received from some of the members on few items. Such observations have been considered and necessary changes have been incorporated. Hence, the revised minutes of the 96th meeting of the Academic Council held on 3rd October, 2025 at 2:00 p.m. in the School of Life Sciences Auditorium, University of Hyderabad Campus, Hyderabad- 500 046 are circulated herewith again

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Members present:

1.	Prof. B. J. Rao	Vice-Chancellor
2.	Dr. Devesh Nigam	Registrar & Ex-Officio Secretary
3.	Shri Thukaram Porika	Controller of Examinations i/c & Convener
	DEANS OF THE SCHOOLS	
4.	Prof. Saroj Panigrahi	Mathematics and Statistics
5.	Prof. Atul Negi	Computer and Information Sciences
6.	Prof. P.K.Suresh	Physics
7.	Prof. Samar Kumar Das	Chemistry
8.	Prof. Anand Kumar Kondapi	Life Sciences
9.	Prof. M. T. Ansari	Humanities & Head, Centre for Buddhist Studies & Head, Centre for Study of Foreign Languages & Centre for Endangered Languages and Mother Tongue Studies (CEL&MTS)
10.	Prof. K. Suneetha Rani	Social Sciences & Head i/c, Centre for Human Rights
11.	Prof. Debashis Acharya	Economics
12.	Prof. M. Samba Siva Raju	S N School of Arts and Communication
13.	Prof. G.V.R.K. Acharyulu	Management Studies
14.	Prof. Ramesh Kumar Mishra	Medical Sciences & Head, Centre for Neural and Cognitive Science
15.	Prof. Jai Prakash Gautam	Engineering Sciences & Technology
	HEADS/ DIRECTORS OF THE DEPARTMENTS / CENTRES	
16.	Prof. Samrat L Sabat	CASEST & Director, Research & Development Cell
17.	Prof. V. Chakravarthi	Centre for Earth Ocean & Atmospheric Sciences
18.	Prof. Naresh Babu V. Sepuri	Biochemistry
19.	Prof. Ragiba Makandar	Plant Sciences
20.	Prof. Kota Arun Kumar	Animal Biology
21.	Prof. M. Venkataramana	Biotechnology and Bioinformatics
22.	Prof. H.A.Nagarajaram	Systems & Computational Biology
23.	Prof. D. Murali Manohar	English
24.	Prof. Laxminarayan Lenka	Philosophy
25.	Prof. Vishnu Ranba Sarwade	Hindi
26.	Prof. P. Ramulu	Telugu
27.	Prof. A.M.Syed Fazlullah	Urdu
28.	Prof. J. Bheemaiah	Centre for Comparative Literature
29.	Prof. Amba P. Kulkarni	Sanskrit Studies

30.	Prof. Kailash Kunhi Krishnan	Political Science
31.	Prof. G. Nagaraju	Sociology
32.	Prof. Romesh Singh	Anthropology
33.	Prof. Vasantha Srinivasa Rao	Centre for Regional Studies & DSW
34.	Dr. Joly Puthussery	Centre for Folk Culture Studies
35.	Prof. Sreepati Ramudu	Centre for the Study of Social Inclusion
36.	Prof. Deepa Srinivas	Centre for Women's Studies
37.	Prof. Ajaya Kumar Sahoo	Centre for Study of Indian Diaspora
38.	Prof. Aruna Bhikshu	Dance
39.	Mr. Suneel Mamadapur	Fine Arts
40.	Prof. Vasuki Belavadi	Music
41.	Prof. Sanjay Subodh	Director, Centre for Integrated Studies (CIS) & Chief Proctor
42.	Dr. K. Ramachandra Rao	Chief Warden i/C
	PROFESSORS	
43.	Prof. B. Sri Padmavati	Mathematics and Statistics
44.	Prof. R. Radha	Mathematics and Statistics
45.	Prof. Tumuluri Suman Kumar	Mathematics and Statistics
46.	Prof. Chakravarthy Bhagvati	Computer and Information Sciences
47.	Prof. Siba Kumar Udgata	Computer and Information Sciences
48.	Prof. Alok Singh	Computer and Information Sciences
49.	Prof. Rajeev Wankar	Computer and Information Sciences & Professor i/c, CMSD
50.	Prof. Salman Abdul Moiz	Computer and Information Sciences & Director, CDLTR
51.	Prof. K. Swarupa Rani	Computer and Information Sciences
52.	Prof. P.S.V.S. Sai Prasad	Computer and Information Sciences
53.	Prof. Satish Narayana Srirama	Computer and Information Sciences
54.	Prof. Srinivasa Rao Battula	Computer and Information Sciences
55.	Prof. N. Rukma Rekha	Computer and Information Sciences
56.	Porf. S. Nagender Kumar	Computer and Information Sciences
57.	Prof. Nirmal Kumar Viswanathan	Physics
58.	Prof. Rukmani Mohanta	Physics
59.	Prof. S. Srinath	Physics
60.	Prof. E. Harikumar	Physics
61.	Prof. V. Subrahmanyam	Physics
62.	Prof. Soma Sanyal	Physics
63.	Prof. K.C. James Raju	CASEST
64.	Prof. S.V.S. Nageswara Rao	CASEST & Professor-in-Charge, Centre for Nano Technology
65.	Prof. S. Venugopal Rao	DIA-CoE-UOH
66.	Prof. Anil Kumar Chaudhary	DIA-CoE-UOH
67.	Prof. Karumuri Ashok	CEOAS
68.	Prof. Susanta Mahapatra	Chemistry
69.	Prof. Samar Kumar Das	Chemistry
70.	Prof. K. Lalitha Guru Prasad	Chemistry
71.	Prof. D.B.Ramachary	Chemistry
72.	Prof. Tushar Jana	Chemistry
73.	Prof. Pradeepta Kumar Panda	Chemistry

74.	Prof. R.Balamurugan	Chemistry
75.	Prof. Akhila Kumar Sahoo	Chemistry
76.	Prof. K. Muralidharan	Chemistry
77.	Prof. Viswanathan Baskar	Chemistry
78.	Prof. Sathiyendiran M	Chemistry
79.	Prof. Perali Ramu Sridhar	Chemistry
80.	Prof. Debashis Barik	Chemistry
81.	Prof. Srinivasarao Yaragorla	Chemistry
82.	Prof. Krishnaveni Mishra	Biochemistry
83.	Prof. Mrinal K. Bhattacharyya	Biochemistry
84.	Prof. Sharmistha Banerjee	Biochemistry
85.	Prof. Pakala Suresh Babu	Biochemistry
86.	Prof. Bramanandam Manavathi	Biochemistry & Director, Office for International Affairs
87.	Prof. Sanotsh Kumar Padhi	Biochemistry
88.	Prof. Gudipalli Padmaja	Plant Science
89.	Prof. S. Rajagopal	Plant Science
90.	Prof. Yelam Sreenivasulu	Plant Sciences
91.	Prof. Santosh R. Kanade	Plant Sciences
92.	Prof. Yellamraju Sreelakshmi	Plant Sciences
93.	Prof. Rahul Kumar	Plant Sciences
94.	Prof. Sribash Roy	Plant Sciences
95.	Prof. B. Senthilkumaran	Animal Biology
96.	Prof. Anita Jagota	Animal Biology
97.	Prof. Sreenivasulu Kurukuti	Animal Biology
98.	Prof. Suresh Yenugu	Animal Biology
99.	Prof. Nooruddin khan	Animal Biology
100.	Prof. A. Bindu Madhava Reddy	Animal Biology
101.	Prof. Radheshyam Maurya	Animal Biology
102.	Prof. K. P.M.S.V. Padmasree	Biotechnology and Bioinformatics
103.	Prof. Vaibhav Vindal	Biotechnology and Bioinformatics
104.	Prof. N. Prakash Prabhu	Biotechnology and Bioinformatics
105.	Prof. Sunanda Bhattacharya	Biotechnology and Bioinformatics
106.	Prof. C. A. Tomy	Philosophy
107.	Prof. B. Ananda Sagar	Philosophy
108.	Prof. Gajendra Kumar Pathak	Hindi
109.	Prof. M. Shyam Rao	Hindi
110.	Prof. Darla Venkateswara Rao	Telugu
111.	Prof. D. Vijaya Lakshmi	Telugu
112.	Prof. Palepu Varija Rani	Telugu
113.	Prof. Triveni Vangari	Telugu
114.	Prof. Bhukya Thirupathi	Telugu
115.	Prof. Ashia Jabeen	Urdu
116.	Prof. Zahidul Haque	Urdu
117.	Prof. R.V. Ramana Murthy	Economics
118.	Prof. B. Nagarjuna	Economics
119.	Prof. Phanindra Goyari	Economics
120.	Prof. S. Raja Sethu Durai	Economics
121.	Prof. Alok Kumar Mishra	Economics

122.	Prof. L. Chinna Mallaiah	Economics
123.	Prof. Jajati Keshari Parida	Economics
124.	Prof. Srijit Mishra	Economics
125.	Prof. Bhangya Bhukya	History
126.	Prof. Y. Swarupa R. Shankar	History
127.	Prof. Sujith Kumar Parayil	History
128.	Prof. B. Eswara Rao	History
129.	Prof. Vasanthi Srinivasan	Political Science
130.	Prof. Kham Khan Suan Hausing	Political Science
131.	Prof. Ramdas Rupavath	Political Science
132.	Prof. E. Venkatesu	Political Science
133.	Prof. L. Lam Khan Piang	Sociology
134.	Prof. J. Anuradha	Dance
135.	Prof. Vinod Pavarala	Communication
136.	Prof. B. Raja Shekhar	Management Studies
137.	Prof. Irala Lokananda Reddy	Management Studies
138.	Prof. Chetan Srivastava	Management Studies
139.	Prof. B. R. Shamanna	Medical Sciences & Chairman, Empowered Committee for Differently Abled Persons (ECDAP)
140.	Prof. Athar Habib Siddiqui	Medical Sciences
141.	Prof. Dibakar Das	SEST
142.	Prof. V. V. S. S. Srikanth	SEST
143.	Prof. S. Sudhakar babu	UGC-MMTTC
	ASSOCIATE PROFESSORS	
144.	Dr. Joby Joseph	Centre for Neural and Cognitive Sciences
	ASSISTANT PROFESSORS	
145.	Dr. Mohd. Kashif	Department of Urdu, School of Humanities
146.	Dr. D. Vijaya Kumari	Department of Telugu, School of Humanities
147.	Dr. Nishat Ahmed	Department of Urdu, School of Humanities
	EXTERNAL MEMBERS	
148.	Prof. T. Vijay Kumar	Department of English, Osmania University and Director, Hyderabad Literary Festival
	STUDENT OBSERVERS	
149.	Mr. Shiva Palepu	President, Students' Union
150.	Ms. Shruti Priya	General Secretary, Students' Union

The Vice-Chancellor & Chairman of the Council extended a warm welcome to all the members of the Academic Council and introduced the new members to the Council.

The Chairman thanked the members whose term on the Council was completed and expressed appreciation for the services rendered by them to the Council.

Then the agenda was then taken up for discussion.

Item No.AC:96:2025:1: Confirmation and action taken on the previous minutes.

1.1 Confirmation of the Minutes of the previous meeting of the Council.

Since no comments/observations have been received from the members, the Minutes of the 95th meeting of the Academic Council held on 25th April, 2025 have been confirmed.

1.2 Action Taken Report on the Minutes of the previous meeting.

The action taken on the Minutes of the 95th meeting of the Academic Council held on 25th April, 2025 have been noted by the Council.

REPORTING ITEMS

Item No.AC:96:2025:2: Letters received from the UGC/MoE/AICTE/NTA/NCTE, etc.,

Letters received from UGC/MoE/AICTE/NTA/NCTE, etc. placed at 2.1 to 2.26 were noted by the Council. The Council was appraised that some of the items have already been implemented/complied with.

2.1	Letter dated 2.4.2025 of UGC on MY Bharat Portal - Experiential Learning Programs providing a wide range of opportunities to engage in real-world projects within both private and public sector organisations.
2.2	Public Notice dated 4.4.2025 of UGC on University Grants Commission (Recognition and Grant of Equivalence to Qualifications obtained from Foreign Educational Institutions) Regulations, 2025.
2.3	Public Notice dated 23.4.2025 of UGC on UGC (Minimum Standards of Instruction for the Grant of Undergraduate Degree and Postgraduate Degree) Regulations, 2025`.
2.4	Letter dated 23.4.2025 of UGC on Implementation of UPI & UPI QR payments facilities for transaction in all Higher Education Institutions (HEIs), in both online and offline channels.
2.5	Letter dated 29.4.2025 of UGC on Curriculum Revision of all academic programmes offered by Universities.
2.6	Public Notice dated 9.5.2025 of UGC on Guidelines for Admission and Supernumerary seats of International Students in Undergraduate and Postgraduate Program in Higher Education Institutions in India.
2.7	Letter dated 30.5.2025 of UGC on Integrating chapters on the dangers of drug abuse in higher education curricula.
2.8	Letter dated 29.5.2025 of UGC on Implementation of Guidelines for Gender Champions in Higher Educational Institutions.
2.9	Letter dated 5.6.2025 of UGC partial modification of the UGC Guidelines for Pursuing Two Academic Programmes Simultaneously.
2.10	Letter dated 10.6.2025 of UGC about directives on implementation of "Regulations on Curbing the Menace of Ragging in Higher Educational Institutions, 2009".
2.11	Letter dated 1.7.2025 of UGC on Requesting HEIs to review and map relevant SWAYAM courses to be offered in the July 2025 Semester, with their existing University curriculum.
2.12	Public Notice dated 9.7.2025 of UGC on Draft Guidelines for Multiple Entry and Multiple Exist in Academic Programmes offered in Higher Education Institutions.

2.13	Public Notice dated 16.7.2025 on discontinuation of UGC-CARE listing of Journals, and develop suggestive parameters for choosing peer-review journals by faculty members, students and the Higher Educational Institutions.
2.14	Letter dated 18.7.2025 of UGC on Implementation of "Accessibility Guidelines and Standards for Higher Education Institutions and Universities.
2.15	Public Notice dated 22.7.2025 of UGC on UGC (Academic Collaboration between Indian and Foreign Higher Education Institutions to offer Twinning Program, Joint Degree, Dual Degree programs) Regulations, 2022 and UGC (Setting up and Operation of Campuses of Foreign Higher Educational Institutions in India) Regulations, 2023.
2.16	Letter dated 30.7.2025 of UGC on Implementation of Disaster Management Initiatives.
2.17	Letter dated 8.8.2025 of UGC on Compliance of Hon'ble Supreme Court of India Order dated 28.7.2025 in the matter of Criminal Appeal No.1425/2025 @ SLP (Crl) No. 13324/2024 and the subsequent National Task Force constituted by Supreme Court of India.
2.18	Public Notice dated 12.8.2025 of UGC about Commission decision regarding the feasibility of offering programmes in the specialisation of healthcare and allied disciplines falling under the NCASHP Act, 2021 in ODL and online mode.
2.19	Public Notice dated 20.8.2025 of UGC on Learning Outcomes based Curriculum Framework (LOCF)
2.20	Letter dated 20.8.2025 of UGC on All India Technical Conference 2025, titled "Beyond Aryabhatta to Infinite Space".
2.21	Letter dated 20.8.2025 of UGC on Extension of last date of admission for academic session July-August, 2025 for Open and Distance Learning (ODL) and Online programmes being offered by recognized / entitled Higher Educational Institutions.
2.22	Letter dated 25.8.2025 of UGC on observance of Vigilance Awareness Week.
2.23	Letter dated 26.8.2025 of UGC on Janjatiya Gaurav Varsh from 15.11.2024 to 15.11.2025.
2.24	Letter dated 4.9.2025 of UGC on Launch of the Official Website of the National Task Force constituted pursuant to Supreme Court Judgment in Criminal Appeal No.1425/2025@SLP (Crl) No. 13324/2024 tilted Amit Kumar & Ors Vs. Union of India & Ors. to discuss and deliberate the issues related to mental health concerns among students, prevention of commission of the suicides in educational institutions and recommend preventive measures.
2.25	Letter dated 4.9.2025 of Promotion of 'Ageing with Dignity' Initiative Pledge through HEIs.
2.26	Letter dated 3.9.2025 of UGC on request for encouraging candidates for registration for IndiaSkills Competition 2025 at Skill India Digital Home (SIDH).

Item No.AC:96:2025:03: Report on admissions to the PG/Int.PG/Ph.D. Programmes for the Academic Year 2025-26:

The report presented by the Controller of Examinations on admission to all programs for the Academic Year 2025-26 was noted by the Council.

The Council resolved to implement online counselling for PG, Integrated PG/UG programs starting from the Academic Year 2026-27, while retaining the existing practice of offline admissions for Ph.D. programs.

Item No.AC:96:2025:04: Report of the SC/ST/OBC/PH Admissions Advisory Committee held on 16.9.2025.

The Council noted the Report of the SC/ST/OBC/PH Admissions Advisory Committee on admissions into various programmes of the University during the Academic Year 2025-26.

Item No.AC:96:2025:05: Minutes of the Meeting of Internal Quality Assurance Cell (IQAC) held on 19.9.2025.

The Council approved the Minutes of the IQAC meeting held on 19.9.2025.

ITEMS FOR CONSIDERATION

Item No.AC:96:2025:06: Holding of XXV Convocation on 7th October 2025:

The Council noted that the 25th Convocation of the University is scheduled to be held on 7 October 2025 at the Brahmakumaris Global Peace Auditorium, Gachibowli, Hyderabad for award of Degrees and Medals to the graduating students and Dr. Krishna Ella, Executive Chairman, Bharat Biotech International Limited will be the Chief Guest.

The Council also noted that a total of 1717 students of all the programme of studies are graduating during the Academic Year 2024-25 and 182 Gold Medals will be awarded. The Council approved for conferment of the Degrees and award of the Gold Medals during the Convocation.

Item No.AC:96:2025:07: Reassignment of *Tadinada Sri Mahalakshmi Medal* from the discontinued M.Tech. (Mineral Exploration) program to the IMSc. (Applied Geology) program.

The Council noted that the University has stopped awarding the Tadinada Sri Mahalakshmi Medal since 2016-17 as the M.Tech. Mineral Exploration programme, the medal was actually instituted for was discontinued. It was further noted that the proposal put forward by the CEOAS on the request of the Donor for reassignment of said medal to the topper in I.M.Sc. (Applied Geology). The Council considered the matter and recommended for being placed in the Executive Council.

Item No.AC:96:2025:08: Report of the Committee Constituted to examine Requirements and Modalities for the award of a Dual Degree involving Foreign Universities - University of Hyderabad and University of Pavia

The Council noted that the subject matter was discussed in its previous meeting and it was resolved a Committee be constituted to provide clarification on the query raised by the Academic Council specifically, for submission of additional details regarding academic and financial matters.

Accordingly, a Committee consisting of following members was constituted.

1. Prof.K. Suneetha Rani, Dean, School of Social Sciences -Chairperson

2. Prof.Vasuki Belavadi, NEP Chair

3. Prof.Brahmanandam Manavathi, Director, OIA, UoH

4. Prof. Madhushree Sekhar, Director, OIA, TISS, Mumbai

5. Mr Thukaram Porika, CoE, UoH

6. Dr S.Shaji, Coordinator, UoH-UNIPV MoU, Member Secretary

The Council considered the recommendations of Committee and agreed to the following:

Academic Matters:

The University of Hyderabad may adopt the TISS Dual Degree model which provides the mobility of students in such a fashion that students, after completing 1st year (2 semesters), can move to partner universities and complete the second-year courses (courses which are complementary or mutually agreed upon by partner universities). Furthermore, once courses are completed in partner universities (in the second year of study for exchange students), the respective universities will transfer the credits to home universities. After the transfer of credits and verification of the successful course completion criteria, each partner will award their respective degrees (for instance, UoH will award an MA in Political Science, and UNIPV will award an MA in African and Asian Studies) to the students. The partnering Universities have to agree on credit transfer criteria through a mutual agreement-Dual Degree Agreement.

Financial Matters/Administrative Matters

The fee for the programme should be mutually agreed upon and should be reflected in the Dual Degree agreement and funding of the programme (if any) should be clearly mentioned in the Dual Degree agreement. All existing rules related to university admissions should be adhered to.

The details about the Dual Degree programme should be included in the UoH admission prospectus so that students are aware of the option of Dual Degree mobility available within the Master's programme that the department offers with the criteria to select the student and the financial liability expected for the programme.

After detailed discussion the Council resolved to accord in-principle approval for execution of programme subject to the condition that the details to be incorporated in the Dual Degree agreement submitted and the Vice-Chancellor, if satisfied with the terms and conditions of the agreement may give his consent. University of Hyderabad has no financial liability in this programme.

Item No.AC:96:2025:09: Incorporation of Uniform Grading Slab

The Council noted that as per the resolution of the Council in its last meeting (95th AC) the responsibility of rationalization of grading slabs was assigned to the NEP Implementation Committee and accordingly, the NEP Implementation Committee have scrutinized the Grading Slabs proposed by the respective Schools and recommended for adoption of Uniform Grading Slabs School-wise as stated in the Minutes.

The Chairman suggested that having a uniform grading percentage across all Schools would be more beneficial. After detailed discussions the Council resolved to accord in-principle approval to the recommendations of the Committee for introducing a Uniform Grading Slabs subject to aligning the grading slabs for I.M.Tech programmes and to harmonize the grading slabs across similar disciplines. The committee shall strive to bring different schools to agree among a few grading tables in line with the requirements of UGC/AICTE. A student will be mapped with the grading table of the school in which he/she is admitted irrespective of courses he/she takes from across the schools.

Item No.AC:96:2025:10: Correction of Marks and Delayed submission of results.

The council reviewed and approved the cases presented by the committee constituted to investigate issues related to marks corrections and delayed result submissions. Further, for the Ph.D students the council approved the results submitted by the academic units in respect of RPE course pertaining to the 2020, 2021 and 2022 batches, as a one time measure, and the thesis of students belonging to the said batches will be processed and they will be issued UGC regulation certificate. It was further resolved that all Academic Units must strictly adhere to the Committee's point-wise recommendations to prevent recurrence of such incidents.

Additionally, certain Science Schools have clarified that Supervisors are not responsible for overseeing coursework completion or mark submission, as these responsibilities are managed by Course Work Coordinators, RAC members, or administrative staff within the respective Academic Units. In light of this, all Academic Units were instructed to comply with the following recommendations of the Committee uniformly, regardless of the current practices followed across different Schools.

1. Henceforth, it will be the responsibility of the Student; Supervisor; RAC; the Course Work Coordinator; and the academic unit Head to ensure that the students complete the coursework as mandated by the UGC. The mode of delivery for these courses will be left to the academic unit. They will also inform the Controller of Examinations' office if any students fail to complete the course work requirements in 2 years.

2. Academic units may want to take advantage of the RPE online course.

3. The RAC report every semester will contain a field that a student's coursework is in progress/ has completed coursework as per UGC norms.

4. Faculty/Heads of academic units will ensure that the results of PhD course work are also submitted--like all other programmes, both on e-gov/ Samarth as well as a hardcopy alongside the results of all other programmes (PG etc).

5. The process leading up to the Viva-voce for M.Tech. and similar programmes shall be completely documented by the Supervisor/ Guide and submitted to Head/Dean.

6. In the case of submission of grades for other PG and Integrated programmes, faculty course instructors will double-check and exercise utmost caution before submitting the marks on the portal.

7. The Head of the academic unit may please go through all the grades and ensure that the printed hard copies downloaded from Samarth/eGov portal are duly signed by the course faculty instructor/ Head/Dean before submission to the CE's office.

8. All academic units to also monitor the use of examination answer sheets, document the serial numbers and examination attendance, and maintain records for up to three years as per university norms.

Item No.AC:96:2025:11: Release of Admission Notification for January-2026 session for Ph.D. programmes.

The proposal for release of admission notification in the month of October 2025 in respect of January 2026 session has been approved by the Council.

MINUTES OF THE SCHOOL BOARDS

Item No.AC:96:2025:12: Minutes of the School Board meeting of School of Life Sciences held on 9.9.2025.

Item No.AC:96:2025:12.1: Introduction of Skill-oriented Industry-enabled 3-month certificate courses at Skill Development Centre.

The resolution of the School Board of School of Life Sciences for offering the following Skill-oriented Industry-enabled 3-month certificate courses to be coordinated by Prof. Y. Suresh at the Skill Development Centre was considered by the Council.

1. Bioreactor Design and Upstream processing of Recombinant Biopharmaceuticals - by Dr. Insaf Qureshi, Dr. Ravi Kant from Department of Biotechnology and Bioinformatics.
2. Downstream Processing of Biopharmaceuticals - by Dr. K.R.R. Roy, Department of Animal Biology.
3. Analytical characterization of recombinant bio-pharmaceutical proteins - by Dr. Ajay T, Department of Biochemistry.
4. From Molecules to Genomes: AI and Computational Modeling for Industrial Innovation - by Dr. Moumita Saharay, Department of Systems and Computational Biology.

The council approved in principle, with a recommendation to confirm whether the three-month course is eligible for certification under the applicable UGC guidelines.

The school subsequently confirmed that as per the National Credit Framework guidelines by UGC, the four courses will be of 6 (six) months duration and will cover the required number of teaching and practical training hours.

Item No.AC:96:2025:12.2: Filling vacant Ph.D. seats for the academic year 2025-26 with students qualified with JRF and NTA scores through advertisement by conducting admission process for every 3 months till vacancies are filled.

Item Dropped.

Item No.AC:96:2025:13: Minutes of the School Board of School of Chemistry:

Item No.AC:96:2025:13.1 Release of Ph.D. admission notification 4 times in a year

Item dropped.

Item No.AC:96:2025:14: Minutes of the School Board meeting of School of Humanities held on 2.9.2025.

Item No.AC:96:2025:14.1: Temporary freeze on admissions to the M.A. (Comparative Literature) program from 2026-27. (SB Item No. HUM:SB:2025:14)

The Council noted that the School Board of School of Humanities had actually resolved to freeze M.A. (Comparative Literature) program run by the Centre for Comparative Literature in view of acute shortage of permanent faculty from the academic year 2026-27.

The Controller of Examinations informed the House that, after circulation of Agenda for AC meeting, he had received an amendment to the above resolution on the above subject from the Dean, School of Humanities, which states as follows:

The members observed that it requires larger deliberation at a higher level. It was also strongly suggested that some of the Centres with acute shortage of permanent faculty could submit a Proposal to UGC with the required data about the number of applications, enrolment and award of degrees since the inception of the M.A. programmes.

In light of the revised resolution as above, the Council resolved to defer the item.

Item No.AC:96:2025:14.2: Panel of Experts for faculty selection (SB Item No. HUM:SB:2025:17)

The Council recommended the panel of experts for faculty positions of Department of English and Department of Philosophy for consideration and approval to the Executive Council.

Item No.AC:96:2025:15: Minutes of the 71st Meeting of School Board of School of Social Sciences held on 10.9.2025.

Item No.AC:96:2025:15.1: Reporting of admission to M.Ed., I.M.A, M.A. and Ph.D. (SB Item No. SB:72:2K25:I(3))

The School Board of School of Social Sciences resolved to give an option to the students to join both **online/offline**, as many students missed attending admission counselling due to genuine reasons. An online admission counselling would facilitate better admissions and fill all the seats announced.

The Item was discussed as part of Item No. 3 above. Thus, the resolution of the Council at Item No. 3 shall apply for this item also.

Item No.AC:96:2025:15.2: Executive Council resolution (EC:194:2025:19/9 dated 27 June 2025) to seek clarification from UGC and withhold promotion to the Senior Professor grade. (SB Item No. SB:71:2K25:I(15) (2))

The Council discussed the issue in detail with reference to the guidelines issued by the UGC. The Registrar briefed the chronological developments and the current status on implementation of the scheme. The Council noted that the University has written a letter to the UGC seeking clarification and way forward in implementation of the scheme. The Council resolved to wait for a clarification to be received from UGC for further course of action.

Item No.AC:96:2025:16: Minutes of the 45th Meeting of School Board of School of Management Studies held on 19.09.2025.

Item No.AC:96:2025:16.1: Introduction of Industry sponsored seats in Executive MBA, tentatively a maximum of 5, and an increase in intake to 120. (SB Item No.1)

The Council approved to earmark 5 Industry sponsored seats in MBA (Executive) program with a fee of Rs.5,50,000/- (Rupees Five Lakh Fifty Thousand only) for the entire program. A separate merit list will be drawn for Industry sponsored seats in the MBA (Executive) program from the Academic Year 2026-27 onwards.

Item No.AC:96:2025:16.2: Extension of eligibility criteria of MBA (Gen) to MAT in addition to CAT and CMAT from the academic year 2026-27 onwards (SB Item No.9)

The Council noted that the School Board of School of Management Studies resolved to extend the admission criteria for the MBA (General) program by accepting MAT and CMAT scores, in addition to the existing CAT score, with effect from the Academic Year 2026–27. The selection criteria for the candidates will be based on normalized Z score for appearing in Group Discussion/Personal Interview.

The resolution of the School was approved.

Item No.AC:96:2025:17: Minutes of the 25th Meeting of School Board of School of Engineering Sciences and Technology held on 12.9.2025.

Item No.AC:96:2025:17.1: Recognition of External Supervisor from ARCI (SB ITem No.SB25.3)

The Council approved the recognition of Dr. Srinivasan Anandan, Scientist - F, ARCI, as External Supervisor.

Item No.AC:96:2025:17.2: Recognition of NMDC Ltd and MIDHANI as External Research Centres of University of Hyderabad(SB Item No.SB25.5)

The Council noted that the School Board of SEST resolved to recommend R&D Centres at NMDC Ltd. and MIDHANI as External Research Centres of the University of Hyderabad for collaborative research and student exchange considering the following advantages:

To enable employees associated with these R&D Centres to enrol/register for the PhD program at SEST-UoH, subject to their successful admission following the entrance examination and interview.

To facilitate the free flow of Integrated PG and PhD students between SEST and the Centres.

To strengthen capacity building and optimize resources at SEST.

To promote the development of industry-relevant quality engineers and researchers.

To enhance industry - academia interaction.

The Council approved the above resolution of the SEST.

Item No.AC:96:2025:18: Minutes of the Meeting of the School Board of S. N. School of Arts and Communication held on 23.9.2025.

Noted

Item No.AC:96:2025:19: Any other matter

Taking NPDF by the Assistant Professor:

The members of the School of Chemistry brought to the notice of the Council a need of bringing change in the eligibility condition prescribed by the University for a faculty to supervise an NPDF. The current condition is that the "faculties taking NPDFs to have produced at least 3 PhDs". The members from the School of Chemistry proposed an amendment for the same as "faculties who are already guiding PhD students". It was contended that when the concerned funding body (e.g., ANRF-NPDF) does not have this requirement of having at least 3 PhDs, then there is no need for the University to impose this criterion and the Assistant Professors shall also be made eligible to take NPDFs.

After a thorough debate it was resolved by the Council to examine the issue with reference to conditions laid down by the UGC in respect of PDFs and an administrative decision may be taken by the Vice-Chancellor in this regard.

The meeting ended with a vote of thanks.

Vice-Chancellor
&
Chairman, Academic Council